ZENTRAL HACK 2026 · AGENT HARNESS

# Spec in.
# Strategy out.



An agent harness for games it has never seen.

Elias · Isaak · Timo

THE TASK · THE INSIGHT

# An unseen game, a fixed budget, only wins count

## The task

**A** $0.03 · 3 min

**B** $0.50 · 10 min

**C** $10 · 30 min

## What research says

**9 / 10**

games where code written by an LLM matches or beats an LLM picking the moves

*Code World Models, Google DeepMind*

## Our insight

**The LLM is the programmer, not the player.**

Everything it writes gets tested by actually running it.

Sources: Zentral Hack 2026 task description; Code World Models for General Game Playing, arXiv 2510.04542.

THE HARNESS

# The LLM writes, our code verifies

spec.md in

strategy.py out

1
**Write**
drafts + a simulator

2
**Verify**
against the spec

3
**Self-play**
real tournament rules

4
**Improve**
challengers vs. champion

5
**Guard**
never a forfeit

↻ repeat while time and money last

HOW WE BUILT IT

# Built like it works: measure, decide, repeat

**10**

games, 4 never tuned on

**120+**

measured runs

**≈ $45**

API cost

Built with Claude Code · 416 automated tests

EPOCH 1

## Ablation

kept only what wins

EPOCH 2

## Tournament conditions

selection = reality

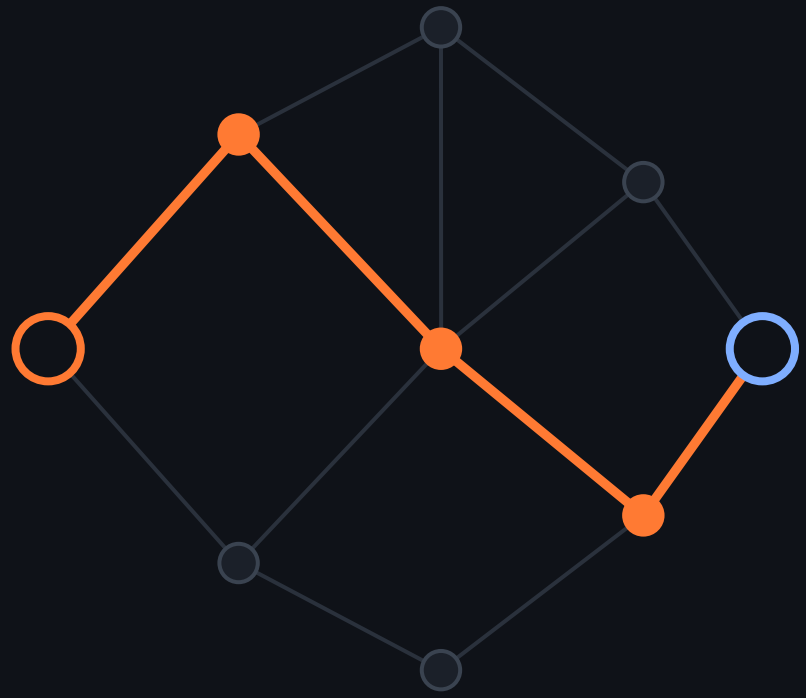
EPOCH 3

## Midpoint feedback ·2 experiments

2 ideas rejected, weak runs traced and fixed

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# Thank you for listening!



Spec in. Strategy out. Never a forfeit.

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